0.4% between 2027 and 2031, down from 0.8% in the previous forecast, although from a higher base. Construction employment is slightly weaker than in the June forecast, declining 1.3% in 2026, compared with 1.1% previously, before returning to growth and reaching 228,300 jobs in 2031. Between 2027 and 2031, construction employment grows at an average annual rate of 1.4%, unchanged from the previous forecast.

Compared with June, the September forecast projects faster income growth, stronger housing activity and lower 2026 inflation

The September forecast anticipates higher nominal personal income growth compared with June. Personal income growth is unchanged in the near term, at 4.1% in 2026, but has been revised upward in every year from 2027 through 2031, averaging 5.4% annually, up from 5.2% in the June forecast. Washington building permits are higher throughout the forecast horizon, with 2026 permits now expected to grow 20.7%, up from 4.8%, reaching 42,100 units. This growth is primarily due to a surge in the multi-family sector. Permits from 2027 to 2031 are expected to average 40,400 units annually, above the June outlook of 39,200. Seattle-area inflation has been revised lower for 2026, now projected at 4.3% compared with 4.6% in the June forecast. Inflation between 2027 and 2031 averages 2.4%, little changed from the prior forecast.

Revenue Forecast

Revenue collections have come in higher than expected

Tracked revenue collections since June have come in $198.9 million above their forecasted amount. The September economic forecast projects higher personal income, employment, and housing permits, all of which have slightly increased forecasted receipts.

Total forecast change by biennium (millions):

25-27: $21.7
27-29: $430.0
29-31: $2,381.5

The forecast of funds subject to the budget outlook process was $76.258 billion in the 2025-27 biennium, $82.594 billion in the 2027-29 biennium, and $94.121 billion in the 2029-31 biennium.

Table 3.17
General Fund-State, Education Legacy Trust Account, Opportunity Pathways Account and Workforce Education Investment Account
History and Forecast by Fiscal Year (Cash basis)
September 2026 - Millions of Dollars

	General Fund-State (GF-S) (current defintion)		Education Legacy Trust Account* (ELTA)		WA Opportunity Pathways Account (OPA)		Workforce Ed. Investment Acct. (WEIA)		Fair Start For Kids Acct. (FSKA)		Total GF-S, ELTA, OPA, WEIA, and FSKA	
	Level	**% Chg.**	**Level**	**% Chg.**	**Level**	**% Chg.**	**Level**	**% Chg.**	**Level**	**% Chg.**	**Level**	**% Chg.**
History:												
FY 2005	$13,036	5.5%									$13,036	5.5%
FY 2006	$14,318	9.8%	$115								$14,432	10.7%
FY 2007	$15,467	8.0%	$266	132.2%							$15,734	9.0%
FY 2008	$15,659	1.2%	$213	-20.1%							$15,872	0.9%
FY 2009	$14,158	-9.6%	$224	5.4%							$14,382	-9.4%
FY 2010	$13,571	-4.1%	$157	-29.9%							$13,728	-4.6%
FY 2011	$14,648	7.9%	$112	-29.0%	$99						$14,859	8.2%
FY 2012	$14,874	1.5%	$114	2.3%	$118	19.1%					$15,107	1.7%
FY 2013	$15,783	6.1%	$101	-11.5%	$126	5.9%					$16,009	6.0%
FY 2014	$16,383	3.8%	$197	95.3%	$114	-9.4%					$16,694	4.3%
FY 2015	$17,283	5.5%	$207	5.0%	$120	5.7%					$17,611	5.5%
FY 2016	$18,579	7.5%	$215	3.6%	$139	15.7%					$18,933	7.5%
FY 2017	$19,739	6.2%	$252	17.5%	$127	-9.0%					$20,118	6.3%
FY 2018	$21,712	10.0%	$302	19.6%	$129	1.5%					$22,143	10.1%
FY 2019	$22,430	3.3%	$1,352	348.1%	$156	21.1%					$23,938	8.1%
FY 2020	$23,817	6.2%	$913	-32.5%	$153	-2.0%	$32				$24,915	4.1%
FY 2021	$26,986	13.3%	$726	-20.5%	$184	20.9%	$320	905.5%			$28,217	13.3%
FY 2022	$30,030	11.3%	$890	22.6%	$190	2.9%	$369	15.1%			$31,478	11.6%
FY 2023	$30,972	3.1%	$1,685	89.4%	$188	-0.7%	$410	11.3%			$33,256	5.6%
FY 2024	$31,094	0.4%	$966	-42.7%	$177	-6.2%	$435	6.1%			$32,672	-1.8%
FY 2025	$32,299	3.9%	$1,462	51.3%	$173	-2.3%	$532	22.1%			$34,465	5.5%
FY 2026	$34,360	6.4%	$2,360	61.4%	$167	-3.3%	$754	41.9%			$37,641	9.2%
Forecast:												
FY 2027	$35,614	3.7%	$1,831	-22.4%	$171	2.5%	$1,001	32.8%			$38,618	2.6%
FY 2028	$36,398	2.2%	$1,354	-26.1%	$169	-1.3%	$1,021	2.0%			$38,942	0.8%
FY 2029	$41,005	12.7%	$1,412	4.3%	$170	0.9%	$1,065	4.3%			$43,652	12.1%
FY 2030	$43,705	6.6%	$1,487	5.3%	$173	1.3%	$1,064	0.0%	175.16		$46,604	6.8%
FY 2031	$44,447	1.7%	$1,551	4.4%	$174	0.7%	$1,093	2.7%	251.56	43.6%	$47,517	2.0%
Biennial Totals												
09-11 Biennium	**$28,218**	**-5.4%**	**$269**	**-38.5%**	**$99**	**NA**	**$0**	**NA**	**$0**	**NA**	**$28,586**	**-5.5%**
11-13 Biennium	**$30,657**	**8.6%**	**$215**	**-19.9%**	**$244**	**145.2%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$0**	**NA**	**$31,116**	**8.8%**
13-15 Biennium	**$33,666**	**9.8%**	**$405**	**88.0%**	**$234**	**-4.1%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$0**	**NA**	**$34,305**	**10.2%**
15-17 Biennium	**$38,317**	**13.8%**	**$467**	**15.4%**	**$266**	**13.6%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$0**	**NA**	**$39,050**	**13.8%**
17-19 Biennium	**$44,143**	**15.2%**	**$1,654**	**254.1%**	**$284**	**6.9%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$0**	**NA**	**$46,081**	**18.0%**
19-21 Biennium	**$50,803**	**15.1%**	**$1,639**	**-0.9%**	**$337**	**18.5%**	**$352**	**NA**	**$0**	**NA**	**$53,132**	**15.3%**
21-23 Biennium	**$61,002**	**20.1%**	**$2,575**	**57.1%**	**$378**	**12.2%**	**$779**	**121.2%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$64,734**	**21.8%**
23-25 Biennium	**$63,392**	**3.9%**	**$2,428**	**-5.7%**	**$349**	**-7.6%**	**$967**	**24.1%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$67,137**	**3.7%**
25-27 Biennium	**$69,974**	**10.4%**	**$4,191**	**72.6%**	**$338**	**-3.3%**	**$1,756**	**81.6%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$76,258**	**13.6%**
27-29 Biennium	**$77,404**	**10.6%**	**$2,765**	**-34.0%**	**$339**	**0.4%**	**$2,086**	**18.8%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$82,594**	**8.3%**
29-31 Biennium	**$88,152**	**13.9%**	**$3,038**	**9.9%**	**$346**	**2.1%**	**$2,157**	**3.4%**	**$0**	**NA**	**$94,121**	**14.0%**

*Education legacy trust fund excluding FY 14 and FY 15 lottery fund transfers. Includes pension stabilization fund interest in FY 08 and FY 09.